NETFLIX

LEADING WITH DATA

Interactive Presentation Narration

A Four-Presenter Stage Script

Full speaking script · handoff cues · stage directions · live-game choreography

Prepared for the team of Kishore Kunal · MDI Gurgaon

How to use this script

This is a word-for-word stage script for four presenters. Everything in normal text is meant to be said aloud — speak it naturally, don't read it robotically. The coloured boxes are for you, not the audience:

STAGE *= a stage direction. What to do with your body, the slide, or the room. Never spoken.*

AUDIENCE = an interactive moment. A question to the room, a vote, or the live game. Slow down and engage here.

HANDOFF = the baton pass. The named cue line is your signal to step back and let the next presenter step up.

The four presenters

Speaking time is balanced so no one carries the room alone, and the highest-energy interactive moment (the live game) sits with the person who has warmed up for it.

Presenter & Role	Owns slides	The vibe to bring
P1 — The Host *Storyteller*	1 – 6	Warm, magnetic opener. Sets the energy for the whole session and tells the human story. Comfortable with a cold-open hook.
P2 — The Analyst *Data guide*	7 – 10	Calm, sharp, credible. Makes numbers feel like a story, not a spreadsheet. Lands the "self-disruption is hard" insight.
P3 — The Showrunner *Game master*	11 – 14	Highest energy. Runs the mind-game and the live "Just One More" countdown. Must be playful and quick on their feet with the room.
(P1 returns) *Bridge 15–16*	15 – 16	The Host steps back in for the two-front war and the streaming twist, keeping the story's voice consistent before the close.
P4 — The Strategist *Facilitator*	17 – 22	Reflective then commanding. Delivers the lessons, runs the Build-an-OTT exercise, and brings the close home.

Total run time: ~22–26 minutes of talking, plus ~8–10 minutes for the Build-an-OTT exercise = roughly a 35-minute slot. Trim the exercise to fit shorter slots.

PART 1 · The Story

Presenter 1 (Host). Goal: hook the room, make them care, and tell the human story of how Netflix began and how Blockbuster fell.

SLIDE 1 Title — Leading with Data

P1 — The Host — *open cold, with confidence*

STAGE *introduce yourselves yet. Open on the hook. Let the $39 vs $1 numbers hang before you explain them.*

In the summer of 2009, two companies in the same business looked at the same screen. One of them was worth thirty-nine dollars a share. The other… less than one dollar.

STAGE *to the two stat chips on the slide as you say each number.*

Same industry. Same customers. Same movies. One was about to rule the world — the other was about to disappear. Tonight isn't really a story about streaming. It's a story about reading change before everyone else feels it — and about how the very same design that built Netflix is, right now, quietly hooking every single one of us.

We're your team for the next half hour. I'm [name], and with me are [names]. Let's rewind to where it started — with a forty-dollar late fee.

WARM-UP (optional) If the room is small, raise your own hand and ask: "Quick honest one — who watched 'just one more episode' past midnight this week?" Don't dwell; it plants a seed you'll harvest in Part 3.

SLIDE 2 Roadmap — Where we're headed

P1 — The Host — *quick, ~25 seconds*

Here's our route. First, the story — how a startup humbled a giant. Then the data behind it. Then the fun part: we turn the lens on you and watch this room get hooked in real time. We'll take a few quick votes, pull out the lessons, and finish by having you design the next great streaming app yourselves.

STAGE *the interactive slides — tap cards 3, 4 and 6 — so people know participation is coming. It primes them to lean in.*

SLIDE 3 Section divider — The Story

P1 — The Host — *transition, one breath*

Part one. The story. A late fee, a red envelope, and the slow fall of a giant.

SLIDE 4 The $40 late fee

P1 — The Host — *storytelling mode — slow down*

1997. A man named Reed Hastings rents Apollo 13. He forgets to return it. Six weeks later he digs it out from under a pile — and the late fee is forty dollars. More than the tape was worth.

STAGE *pause. Let the irritation land — most of the room has felt this exact feeling.*

And here's the moment that changed everything. He's embarrassed. He doesn't want to tell his wife. And on the way to the gym he thinks: *wait — the gym has a better model than the video store. I pay one flat fee a month, and I use it as much or as little as I want. No penalties.*

STAGE *point to the 'OLD WAY' vs 'NETFLIX WAY' cards as you contrast them.*

The old way: pay per rental, plus postage, plus late fees, plus the anxiety of forgetting. The Netflix way: one flat monthly fee, no due dates, no late fees — keep the movie as long as you like. That's it. That's the whole idea that toppled an empire. He didn't build a better video store. He removed the thing everyone hated.

SLIDE 5 Blockbuster's rise and fall

P1 — The Host — *build the arc, then the punchline*

Now meet the giant. Blockbuster. In 1985 it's tiny. By the late 80s it explodes — from 133 stores to a thousand in two years — on its way to thirty-four hundred stores worldwide. At its peak, sales to Blockbuster were nearly half of every studio's income. This was Goliath.

STAGE *the timeline left to right with your hand as you hit each node.*

Then the cracks. A third of those stores were overseas, hard to stock on time. They lost key leaders. And the DVD let studios sell straight to Walmart and rivals — so by 2003, Walmart, not Blockbuster, was the number-one source of studio income. By 2009? Under a dollar a share.

STAGE *point to the bottom line on the slide and slow right down.*

And here's the lesson in one line — remember it, because it comes back at the end. Blockbuster defended its model. Netflix attacked its own.

SLIDE 6 Three levers to win a customer

P1 — The Host — *the analytical spine — crisp*

So how do you actually win in this business? Every rental company pulls the same three levers, and Netflix re-engineered all three. Selection — freed from physical shelves, they carried vastly more titles; over two hundred subgenres against Blockbuster's mainstream wall. Convenience — yes, the mail took a few days, but you could keep films as long as you liked, which killed the real pain. And price.

STAGE *the price card — this is the sharpest insight on the slide.*

Watch the price trick carefully. A flat subscription, no due date — it feels like total freedom. But the late fees never disappeared. They were quietly folded into one predictable monthly price. The psychology beat the maths. Hold that thought — because that same psychology is about to show up in your own pocket.

HANDOFF **P1 (Host) → P2 (Analyst).** *Cue: "Feels like freedom — but does the data back it up? Over to our numbers."*

PART 2 · The Data

Presenter 2 (Analyst). Goal: make the numbers feel like a story. Keep it punchy — you are not giving a finance lecture. Land two ideas: the market was tilting, and self-disruption is hard precisely because the business was thriving.

SLIDE 7 Section divider — The Data

P2 — The Analyst — *take the stage calmly*

Thanks [P1]. Part two — the data. And I promise, just four numbers and one chart. Because the numbers don't just describe this story — they predicted it.

SLIDE 8 Exhibit 1 — The market was turning

P2 — The Analyst — *let the chart do the talking*

STAGE *to the grouped bars — grey is 2007, red is 2008 — then move to the readout cards on the right.*

Look at the whole market in a single year. In-store rental — the big grey bar, Blockbuster's heartland — is shrinking, down seven percent. Now look at everything digital. By-mail rental, up nineteen percent. Subscription video-on-demand, up sixty-nine percent. The physical world is flat to falling; the digital world is surging.

This is the tide coming in. And the crucial thing is — Hastings could see this. Anyone reading these numbers in 2008 could see exactly where the puck was going. The question was never 'is change coming.' It was 'do you move before it arrives.'

SLIDE 9 Exhibits 2 & 3 — A profitable disruptor

P2 — The Analyst — *set up the irony*

STAGE *the two lines with your finger — red is revenue, gold is net income.*

Now here's the cruel part. Look how well Netflix was doing. Revenue climbing from one billion to one-point-three-six billion — up thirty-seven percent in two years. Net income up sixty-nine percent. This is a healthy, growing, profitable company.

STAGE *pause before the line below — it's the whole point of the slide.*

And that is exactly why self-disruption is so hard. When the thing you'd have to cannibalise is the thing making you rich, every instinct says 'don't touch it.' The lesson in one line: cannibalise yourself — before someone else does it for you.

SLIDE 10 The data flywheel

P2 — The Analyst — *reveal the real moat*

But here's what most people miss. Netflix's real advantage was never the DVDs — and it wasn't even streaming. It was this flywheel. Underneath that simple red website sat over a million lines of code, doing one thing: learning you.

STAGE *the flywheel with your hand — you rate, Cinematch learns, suggestions improve, you watch more, and round it goes.*

You rate and watch. The system — they called it Cinematch — learns. The suggestions get sharper. You watch more. And every loop makes the next loop better. The proof? **Sixty percent of everything queued came straight from recommendations.**

They were so serious about it they ran a one-million-dollar public contest — the Netflix Prize — to crowdsource a better algorithm. They had two hundred-plus subgenres, down to fifteen kinds of anime. And the masterstroke: they used watch-data to decide how much to pay for films — predicting roughly two hundred and fifty thousand rentals for a documentary before they'd even bought it. Data wasn't the back office. Data was the strategy.

HANDOFF **P2 (Analyst) → P3 (Showrunner).** *Cue: "So Netflix learned to out-think Blockbuster. But here's the uncomfortable bit — it also learned to out-think you. [P3] is going to prove it."*

PART 3 · The Mind Game (the centerpiece)

Presenter 3 (Showrunner). This is the high-energy heart of the talk. Tone: playful, knowing, a little cheeky — never preachy or judgmental. You are letting the room catch themselves in the act. Commit fully to the live game; half-effort kills it.

SLIDE 11 Section divider — The Mind Game

P3 — The Showrunner — *step forward, lift the energy*

Alright — my favourite part. We've talked about how Netflix out-thought a giant. Now let's talk about how it out-thinks you. And me. Every single night.

SLIDE 12 Six design tricks that keep you watching

P3 — The Showrunner — *fast, fun — don't read all six flatly*

Six little tricks. Watch how many you recognise. The Hook — a preview autoplays before you even decide, because momentum beats willpower. No stopping cues — the next episode just rolls; there's no natural 'okay, I'm done' moment. A row literally called 'Made for You' — with your name on it. The match percentage — 'ninety-seven percent match' — because a number feels like proof. 'Leaving soon' and 'Top 10' — manufactured scarcity, pure FOMO. And the artwork itself, A/B-tested for you specifically — the thumbnail is bait.

ASK THE ROOM Point at the cards and ask, grinning: "Be honest — which of these got you last night?" Take two or three shout-outs. Keep it light and self-aware. Then: "Let me show you the most powerful one of all — live."

SLIDE 13 THE LIVE GAME — "Just One More"

P3 — The Showrunner — *the centerpiece — ~90 seconds, full commitment*

STAGE *This is a four-step live demo. Run it exactly in order. Keep your own energy high; the room mirrors you.*

STEP 1 · Set the scene Say it slowly, paint the picture:

Picture this. It's eleven p.m. on a weeknight. You told yourself 'just one episode.' That episode just ended. You've got work tomorrow. So — hands up right now, honestly — who is switching it off and going to sleep?

STAGE *Count the hands out loud. "Okay — one, two… about fifteen of you. Good, responsible people. Remember that number."*

STEP 2 · Start the countdown Now BECOME the autoplay timer. This is the moment — sell it.

Because here's what Netflix does. The second that episode ends, a little timer appears in the corner. And it starts counting. Ten…

STAGE *Count down out loud and a little dramatically, watching the hands. "Nine… eight… seven…" Most hands will waver and drop. "Six… five… and the next episode is already playing."*

STEP 3 · Reveal the trick Point at the hands that dropped. Smile.

Look at that. Fifteen hands a moment ago — now look how many. The number didn't change because you got weak. It changed because that ten-second timer is making the decision for you. You never actually chose to keep watching. You just… didn't choose to stop in time.

STEP 4 · Debrief Bring it home — this is the insight the whole game exists for.

And that's the genius, and the warning. Netflix never asked you 'do you want another episode?' Because if it asked, you might say no. Instead, it removed the moment where you'd decide. It didn't fight your willpower — it deleted the place you'd use it. That is the most powerful design idea in this entire talk.

STAGE *If the room doesn't drop hands (small or shy crowd), play it for laughs: "Look at you all — strongest willpower I've seen! Netflix would lose money in this room." Then deliver the debrief anyway.*

SLIDE 14 You Decide — four quick-fire votes

P3 — The Showrunner — *keep momentum — don't over-explain*

Let's do four lightning votes. Hands up, no wrong answers, move fast.

Q1 "Who's watched 'one more' past midnight?" — (callback to the game; expect most hands). "Exactly. We just felt why."

Q2 "Do you trust a '97% match' more, or a 5-star average more? Hands for the match… hands for stars." Then ask one person simply: "why?"

Q3 "Here's a hard one. Blockbuster had data too. So why didn't they use it — complacency, the cost of changing, or company culture?" Take a couple of answers; this bridges back to the story.

Q4 "Last one. Subscription, or pay-per-view — which FEELS cheaper?" Let them answer, then reveal: "Right — but remember slide six. The late fees never left. They were baked into the subscription. It only feels cheaper."

HANDOFF **P3 (Showrunner) → P1 (Host) — briefly.** *Cue: "Now — [P1] is going to bring us back to the battlefield, because while Netflix was hooking customers, it was fighting a war on two fronts."*

Handoff note: Slides 15–16 return to the story. You can keep these with P1 for narrative continuity, OR give them to P3 to maintain momentum. The script below is written for P1; swap the name tag if you prefer P3 to continue.

Bridge · The War and the Next Wave

Slides 15–16. Default speaker: P1 (Host) returns for narrative continuity. These two slides close the historical story and set up the lessons.

SLIDE 15 The two-front war

P1 — The Host — *back to story mode*

While Netflix was busy hooking customers, it was fighting two giants at once. On one side, Blockbuster fought back — 'no late fees' in 2005, which cost it four hundred million dollars; then 'Total Access' in 2006, rent online and return in store. Both failed, because the rules were too constricting. Customers just walked.

STAGE *gesture to the second column — the bigger threat.*

On the other side, something scarier. In late 2002, Walmart launched its own DVD subscription — and Netflix's stock crashed to two dollars fifty. Real fear. But Hastings made a bet: Walmart would never be as focused on this as Netflix was. He was right. By 2005 Walmart retreated — and ended up cross-promoting Netflix. The lesson: focus, and a cleaner promise, can beat raw scale.

SLIDE 16 Act 5 — Streaming threatened Netflix itself

P1 — The Host — *the twist — set up the irony*

And now the twist that makes this story brilliant. The exact same wave Netflix rode to kill Blockbuster… was about to come for Netflix. Streaming could upend DVD-by-mail just as mail had upended stores. Apple, Amazon, Hulu, iTunes, YouTube — all closing in.

STAGE *to the 'flags' on the left, then the red 'window' card.*

So Netflix planted its flags early — Watch Instantly, streaming through the Xbox, onto Vizio and LG TVs, the Roku box for the living room. But here's the genius move: timing. In 2008 the median home internet was just two-point-three megabits, and fifteen percent of homes were still on dial-up. Streaming wasn't ready for the masses yet — which meant Netflix had a window to build the future while the DVD cash cow was still paying the bills. Read the wave early; move before it breaks.

HANDOFF **P1 (Host) → P4 (Strategist).** *Cue: "So what do we actually take from all this? [P4] is going to pull out the lessons — and then hand the stage to you."*

PART 4 · Lessons, Exercise & Close

Presenter 4 (Strategist / Facilitator). Tone: start reflective and thoughtful for the lessons, then shift to warm and commanding to run the exercise and close. You are landing the meaning and handing ownership to the audience.

SLIDE 17 Section divider — Key Takeaways

P4 — The Strategist — *slow the tempo — this is what they write down*

Thank you [P1]. Strip away the DVDs, the streaming, even Netflix itself — and you're left with six lessons that outlive all of it. These are the ones worth writing down.

SLIDE 18 Six lessons from Netflix

P4 — The Strategist — *don't read all six flatly — dwell on two*

STAGE *Pick the two that matter most to this audience (usually #1 and #3) and spend real time there. Name the others briefly — they can read the slide.*

One — and this is the big one. Disrupt yourself first. Whoever is willing to cannibalise the model controls the timing. Blockbuster waited for someone else to do it, and lost. Two — data compounds, but physical assets decay. Three-thousand-four-hundred stores became a liability overnight; every rating made Netflix permanently stronger.

Three — and remember the late fee — fix the feeling, not the feature. They didn't build a better store; they erased an anxiety. Four — your operational data is your strategy; watch-history became a pricing weapon. Five — plant flags before the market is ready. And six — yesterday's strength can become tomorrow's trap. That iconic red envelope was a gift in the mail era… and a liability in streaming.

SLIDE 19 Section divider — Build-an-OTT

P4 — The Strategist — *energy up — hand them the stage*

Now it's your turn. Everything we've learned — the hooks, the data, the lessons — you're about to use it. We're going to design the next great streaming app, right here, in teams.

SLIDE 20 The exercise — Pitch your OTT app

P4 — The Strategist — *give clear instructions, then start the clock*

RUN THE EXERCISE Read the four mission steps aloud, point to the idea-starters, then set a timer. Teams of 4–5, six minutes to build, ~90 seconds each to pitch.

Here's the brief. Get into teams of four or five. You have six minutes. Step one — pick ONE audience. Gen-Z bingers, busy parents, regional-language fans — choose one and design only for them. Step two — name your three must-win features: what hooks them on day one, and what keeps them past month one. Step three — use data smartly: what do you collect, and what does it unlock for the user? And step four — the important one — pick one 'dark pattern' you refuse to use, and tell us why.

STAGE *to the idea-starters panel: "If you're stuck, steal, remix, or reject any of these — but original ideas score higher."*

That fourth step matters most. We just spent ten minutes seeing how easy it is to trap attention. The best builders earn it instead. Your clock starts… now.

STAGE *Walk the room. Nudge stuck teams with one question: "who exactly is this for?" At one minute left, call it out.*

SLIDE 21 The rubric — what makes a winning idea

P4 — The Strategist — *show BEFORE pitches, then host them*

STAGE *Display this rubric while teams are still building so they design toward it. Then use it to frame each pitch.*

As you build — and as we listen — here's what we're looking for. Audience fit: does every feature serve your one user, or is it feature soup? The hook: is there a clear reason to open it on day one? The retention loop: what brings them back in week four — without a dark pattern? Data leverage: does your data make the product smarter, not just creepier? And ethics: did you protect the user as deliberately as you hooked them?

PITCHES Invite 2–3 teams to pitch (~90 seconds each). After each, react warmly and name which rubric point they nailed. Keep it celebratory, not critical.

And the line to remember through all of it: the best products earn attention. They don't just trap it.

SLIDE 22 Closing

P4 — The Strategist — *bring it all home*

STAGE *If your teammates have been seated, bring them back up beside you for the close — finish as a unit.*

So — the point was never streaming. It was reading the wave before everyone else feels the water. Netflix saw a forty-dollar late fee and felt an entire industry shifting. They disrupted themselves before anyone could do it to them. They let their data compound while their rivals' stores gathered dust. And they learned to earn attention — which, as builders, is the line we get to choose not to cross.

Disrupt yourself. Let data compound. Earn attention — don't trap it. Thank you so much — we'd love to take your questions.

Q&A Open the floor. If it's quiet, seed it: "What's one app on your phone right now that's using these exact tricks on you?"

One-glance cheat sheet

Tape this to the lectern. The whole flow in one view.

Slides	Who	Beat / action
1–6	**P1 Host**	Story: $39 vs $1 hook → the $40 late fee → Blockbuster falls → three levers (watch the price trick).
7–10	**P2 Analyst**	Data: market tilting (Exhibit 1) → profitable yet must self-disrupt → the data flywheel is the real moat.
11–14	**P3 Showrunner**	Mind game: 6 hooks → LIVE "Just One More" countdown (the centerpiece) → 4 quick-fire votes.
15–16	**P1 Host**	Bridge: two-front war (Blockbuster + Walmart) → the twist: streaming threatens Netflix; timing was everything.
17–22	**P4 Strategist**	Six lessons (dwell on #1 & #3) → run Build-an-OTT exercise → show rubric → close as a unit → Q&A.

Golden rules for the four of you

- The live countdown (Slide 13) is the moment people remember — P3 must commit fully, not rush it.
- Never break the baton: when you hear your cue line, the current speaker steps back and you step up. Practise the six handoffs out loud at least once.
- Keep the mind-game playful, not preachy. You're helping the room catch themselves, not scolding them.
- Make the ethics thread explicit — it ties the mind game (P3) to the exercise rubric (P4). That link is what elevates this from 'Netflix is clever' to 'what kind of builder do you want to be.'
- Watch the clock on the exercise. If the slot is tight, cut to one team pitching rather than three.
- Finish together — all four standing for the close lands far stronger than one person trailing off.